Local Maintenance Lead - Roles & Responsibilities

Volunteer: [Name]

Mandir: [Mandir name]

Department: Local Maintenance Team

Reports to: National Maintenance Team, through the State Maintenance Lead, for major maintenance work

Work Closely with: Mandir Coordinator, Pujarishri, State Maintenance Lead, National Maintenance Team, Local Accounts Team and local departments (Kitchen, AV, Security, Festival teams)

Version Control

Version	Date	Effective Date	Author / Owner	Approved by	Summary of Changes
1.0	11/11/2026		National Maintenance Team		Initial Draft

Complete one copy of this document for each mandir's Local Maintenance Lead.

1) Planned and Routine Maintenance

Regular, planned maintenance keeps the mandir safe and avoids costly breakdowns. The Local Maintenance Lead looks after the site day to day and follows the national framework.

a) Carry out the mandir's 12-month maintenance calendar and record each task when done.
b) Follow the National Maintenance Framework standards, procedures, templates and checklists.
c) Support the annual condition inspection of major assets and equipment.
d) Report changes in asset condition, so the asset register and 7-year lifecycle plan stay accurate.
e) Suggest improvements to national standards and procedures from local experience.

2) Faults and Minor Repairs

Every fault is logged and prioritised, so it is fixed in time and within approved spending limits.

a) Log every fault and request in the maintenance system and assign a priority:
    i) **P1 Emergency** – make safe immediately; contractor on site within 4 hours.
    ii) **P2 Urgent** – within 48 hours.
    iii) **P3 Routine** – within 14 days.
    iv) **P4 Planned** – as per the maintenance calendar.
b) Handle minor and routine repairs within local delegation, using approved contractors.
c) **Spending limits per job**
    i) Up to $2,000 (Type A and B centres) or $1,000 (Type C centres): approve within local allocation.
    ii) $1,001 – $5,000 (above the local limit): get State Maintenance Lead approval, and keep the Mandir Coordinator informed.
    iii) Capital and major works: raise with the State Maintenance Lead for the CAPEX workflow.
d) Escalate to the State Maintenance Lead any issue that cannot be resolved locally or is beyond local delegation.

3) Emergencies

In an emergency, people's safety comes first, followed by protecting the building and its contents.

a) Make the site safe in an emergency (for example flooding, fire system fault, gas leak, power loss, storm damage or security breach).
b) Notify the State Maintenance Lead straight away, and the Mandir Coordinator. For P1 events, the National Maintenance Admin must also be told at once.
c) Call an approved contractor and keep a record of what happened and what was done.
d) Support the National Maintenance Team with insurer notifications and incident reviews.

4) Major Maintenance Work

Major work is approved and controlled by the National Maintenance Team. The Local Maintenance Lead raises the need and supports the work on site.

a) Raise any proposed major work with the State Maintenance Lead **before** seeking quotes or committing to anything.
b) Major work includes, for example:
   i) Structural work, extensions, demolition or changes to layout or use.
   ii) Work needing council or certifier approval, or on a heritage item.
   iii) Electrical, plumbing, drainage or gas work beyond like-for-like minor repairs.
   iv) Work on major fire safety systems, lifts or emergency exits.
   v) Roof work, work at heights, scaffolding, platforms or cranes.
   vi) Work that may disturb asbestos (any building built before 2004 is assumed to possibly contain asbestos).
   vii) Hot work, tree removal, new signage, or changes to car parks, driveways or stormwater.
   viii) Any job above the CAPEX threshold, or at a leased mandir needing landlord consent.
c) Do not let major work start until the National Maintenance Compliance & Permits Lead has confirmed all permits, licences, approvals and insurances are in place. This hold point may not be overridden locally.
d) Provide site information and support on site while the work is underway.

Pre-start checklist (complete and record sign-off)

- ☐ Scope of work approved by the National Maintenance Team
- ☐ Funding approved through the CAPEX workflow
- ☐ All required permits and approvals obtained or confirmed not needed, with reasons recorded
- ☐ Contractor licences and insurances checked and filed
- ☐ Asbestos register checked and hazardous materials managed
- ☐ SWMS, site induction and site safety plan in place
- ☐ Mandir Coordinator informed; work in or near the Sinhasan arranged respectfully and in consultation with the Pujarishri
- ☐ Timing checked against the festival and event calendar
- ☐ Devotees, neighbours and landlord notified where needed
- ☐ Sign-off by the local maintenance team is recorded

5) Permits and Approvals

The Local Maintenance Lead is responsible for, or checks, the following permits and approvals at the mandir:

Item	Typically issued by	Local Maintenance Lead responsibility
Plumbing, drainage and gas compliance certificates	Licensed plumber or gasfitter	Check the contractor has lodged it; file a copy

Item	Typically issued by	Local Maintenance Lead responsibility
Electrical certificate of compliance	Licensed electrician	Check the contractor has lodged it; file a copy
Asbestos survey, licensed removal and clearance certificate	Licensed assessor and removalist	Arrange with the WHS lead; file the clearance
Hot work, roof access and confined space permits	Mandir Coordinator	Obtain before work starts, with State Maintenance Lead approval where required
Road, footpath, crane or skip bin permits	Local council or road authority	Check the contractor holds the permit
Tree removal permit	Local council	Obtain before work starts
Landlord consent (leased sites)	Landlord or managing agent	Obtain in writing before work starts

6) Contractors on Site

Every contractor working at the mandir must be approved, licensed, insured and inducted.

a) Book contractors only from the approved contractor list for your state.
b) **Check every contractor on arrival:**
    i) Site sign-in and induction completed.
    ii) Current trade licence on file, and high risk work licence where needed.
    iii) Public liability insurance of at least $20 million and workers compensation (or sole-trader cover) on file.
    iv) SWMS in place for high-risk work.
    v) Working with Children Check where workers may have contact with children during mandir activities.
c) Supervise contractors on site and stop work that is unsafe.
d) Report contractor performance issues to the State Maintenance Lead.

7) Compliance and Safety

Statutory testing and safe work practices are required by law and protect everyone at the mandir.

a) Arrange access for statutory compliance testing (fire safety, emergency lighting, electrical testing, backflow, lifts) and file the certificates.
b) Act on compliance reminders from the national team before items fall due.
c) Keep the mandir's asbestos and hazardous materials register available and check it before any work.
d) Follow national WHS procedures, including for volunteers working at heights, with ladders, power tools or chemicals.
e) Make sure volunteers with trade licences do licensed work only under their own licence and insurance, as approved by the National Maintenance Team.
f) Report incidents, near misses and safety concerns promptly.

8) Working with the Mandir

Maintenance work must fit respectfully around mandir activities.

a) Coordinate with the Mandir Coordinator and other departments (kitchen, AV, security, festival teams) so work fits around mandir activities.
b) Arrange any work in or near the Sinhasan respectfully and in consultation with the Pujarishri.
c) Check timing against the festival and event calendar (for example Diwali and Annakut, Janmashtami, Ram Navami and Shibir weekends).
d) Notify devotees, neighbours and the landlord where needed.

9) Reporting and Meetings

Regular reporting lets the national team support the mandir and plan ahead.

a) **Send a one-page monthly report** to the national team at least 5 working days before the national meeting, covering:
    i) Open and completed work orders, with any overdue items.
    ii) Planned maintenance completed vs scheduled.
    iii) Compliance items due in the next 90 days.
    iv) Incidents, near misses and safety concerns.
    v) Proposed major work or capital needs.
    vi) Spend against local allocation.
    vii) Help needed from the National Maintenance Team.
b) Attend the monthly national meeting, or send a briefed delegate.
c) Attend ad hoc meetings when called (for example after an emergency or before major work).
d) Complete actions assigned in the national action log by their due date.

10) Records and Site Information

Good records make the mandir audit-ready and help the next volunteer pick up the work.

a) Keep site records, keys and access details current.
b) File completion certificates, compliance certificates, warranties and manuals in the shared central location.
c) Close each job in the maintenance system when the work is complete.

11) Local Team and Succession

A strong local team keeps the mandir maintained even when the Local Maintenance Lead is away.

a) Build a local maintenance team of volunteers sized to the site, with engineering, trades or facilities skills where possible.
b) Train and nominate at least one backup for the Local Maintenance Lead role.

c) Take part in national training on the framework, safety, the asset register and reporting tools.
d) Strengthen samp within the team and do seva to earn Swami's Rajipo.